7 The Blugermans had a television set now, and when we were staying at their apartment, we watched it as much as we could.

Waltham

After we got back from New York, things began looking up. The obstetrician finally detected signs of life, and for that matter, so did Gertrude.

Then, on March 28, 1951, we finally found the apartment we were looking for. It was in Waltham, about nine miles due west of the Medical School and near a public transportation line, though not a fearfully convenient one. (Still, we now had a car.)

It was a four-room apartment, with two bedrooms—one of which I could use as a study until we had to convert it into a nursery. It had a beautiful kitchen, a pleasant hall, adequate closet space, and most of all, it was the top floor of a two-story house so that it had four-way ventilation—even a small veranda. The rent was $100 a month, which we could swing on my school salary alone, and with the writing earnings added, there would be no trouble.

Two days later we closed the deal, and for once I was certain we were doing the right thing.

At least I knew we were right as far as the apartment was concerned. I wasn't at all sure I should stay on the job. It would have been nice to get some commitment of advancement before I took a new and more expensive apartment, but the developing fetus wouldn't wait, so neither could I.

On March 30, I mentioned the possibility of a raise in pay to Lemon and he looked at me blankly as though he had never heard the phrase before and wondered what it meant.

On April 5,1 sought a conference with Dr. Walker (who had been away from school for some time because his mother-in-law had died) and, for the first time, explained that I wanted to be a full member of the faculty with my salary coming from school funds and not from Dr. Lemon's grant. After that, more or less by coincidence, Lemon saw Walker and explained how unsatisfactory I was. Of course, the news of that got to me and raised my anger several notches.

On April 9, Walker and Lemon had a conference with Dean Faulkner and it was decided that I would not get a professorship, though I would get a raise.